

INNOVATION IN ACADEMIA

A faculty transformation lab for stronger patents, funded research and industry relevance

⚡ **VALUE PROMISE:** Research novelty • Patent potential • Fundable partnerships

01

PROGRAM



AUDIENCE

Teachers & academic leaders



DURATION

1 day | 9:30-17:00



FORMAT

Hands-on studio



CUSTOM PROGRAM

Discuss with us

■ Why this matters now

FOR ACADEMIC LEADERS

Turn faculty expertise into a visible pipeline of novel research, defensible IP and fundable partnerships.

WHY STUDENTS NEED IT

Research scholars learn to identify consequential problems, build inventive confidence and see how research becomes IP and real-world impact.

WHY ACADEMICIANS NEED IT

Faculty move beyond incremental publication, strengthen novelty and create credible paths to patents, funded research and industry partnerships.

■ What we will explore

- Build an inventive mindset for research, teaching and institutional challenges.
- Separate genuine novelty from routine extensions of existing work.
- Use structured frameworks to connect evidence, IP and stakeholder value.

■ What participants gain

- **Find novelty:** identify innovative, relevant problems worth solving.
- **Escape the publication trap:** move from incremental papers to defensible contribution.
- **Create IP:** shape novel, non-obvious and patent-ready concepts.
- **Attract support:** build credible industry and government-funding pathways.

INSTITUTIONAL RETURN

A stronger pipeline of patentable research, fundable proposals and industry-facing faculty initiatives.

From novelty to evidence, IP and partnership

A clear one-day journey, followed by reusable tools and a practical continuation path.

■ One-day learning journey

09:30-10:15	Beyond the next paper	Recognise the iterative publication trap and define meaningful impact.
10:15-11:15	Novel problem discovery	Scan tensions, unmet needs, anomalies and emerging opportunity landscapes.
11:30-12:45	Storytelling for relevance	Connect evidence, beneficiaries, urgency and a compelling research question.
13:45-15:00	Framework lab	Use TRIZ contradictions, inventive principles and structured idea generation.
15:15-16:15	Reverse brainstorming and IP lens	Expose failure modes and test novelty and non-obviousness.
16:15-17:00	Impact pathway	Map experiments, patent steps, industry partners and suitable funding routes.

■ Who should attend

- University and college teachers
- Heads of department and deans
- Research supervisors and lab leaders
- Curriculum, accreditation and faculty-development teams

■ Methods & tools

- Novel problem and opportunity landscapes
- Research storytelling for relevance
- TRIZ contradictions and principles
- Reverse brainstorming
- Publication-to-patent decision lens
- Industry collaboration and funding canvas

■ Takeaway toolkit

- A portfolio of consequential, underexplored research problems
- A novelty and non-obviousness canvas for a selected idea
- Concepts generated using TRIZ and reverse brainstorming
- A 30-day experiment, IP and stakeholder-engagement roadmap

■ Custom program

Custom programs can be discussed

The scope can be shaped around the cohort, institutional priorities and desired outcomes. Workbook, innovation tool cards, IP lens, funding canvas and participation certificate can be included.

THE MODERN-DAY PROFESSIONAL

An institutional capability lab for employability, innovation confidence and industry readiness

⚡ **VALUE PROMISE:** Graduate readiness • Applied problem-solving • Employer connection



AUDIENCE

Students & early-career talent

DURATION

1 day | 9:30-17:00

FORMAT

Interactive bootcamp

CUSTOM PROGRAM

Discuss with us

■ Why this matters now

FOR ACADEMIC LEADERS

Strengthen graduate employability and institutional industry relevance through applied problem-finding, storytelling and innovation.

WHY STUDENTS NEED IT

Students develop employer-valued problem-finding, storytelling, AI judgement and collaboration skills beyond grades and technical knowledge.

WHY ACADEMICIANS NEED IT

Academics connect curriculum and mentoring to employability, interdisciplinary projects and stronger institutional engagement with industry.

■ What we will explore

- Build the capability portfolio of an adaptable, modern professional.
- Strengthen problem-finding, communication, digital fluency and ethical judgement.
- Translate academic work into language valued by employers and partners.

■ What participants gain

- **Find opportunity:** recognise novel problems with academic and industry relevance.
- **Show contribution:** frame work around outcomes rather than publication count alone.
- **Build an IP mindset:** recognise potentially novel, non-obvious solution elements.
- **Win collaboration:** communicate a credible value case to employers and funders.

INSTITUTIONAL RETURN

Stronger employability evidence, industry-ready student projects and more purposeful placement engagement.

Build capability beyond technical competence

A structured day for problem-finding, professional storytelling, AI judgement, inventive thinking and opportunity creation.

■ One-day learning journey

09:30-10:15	The changing professional	Explore AI, ambiguity and the new combination of human and digital strengths.
10:15-11:15	Find problems worth solving	Connect trends, stakeholder pain points and personal capability.
11:30-12:45	Storytelling that travels	Present evidence, contribution and impact for interviews and influence.
13:45-15:00	Inventive problem-solving	Use TRIZ patterns, contradictions and practical idea selection.
15:15-16:15	Reverse brainstorming and IP awareness	Uncover risks and identify defensible solution elements.
16:15-17:00	Opportunity pitch	Build relationship capital and a 60-day collaboration and growth sprint.

■ Who should attend

- Final-year undergraduate and postgraduate students
- Doctoral scholars, research associates and early-career faculty
- Placement and student-development cohorts

■ Methods & tools

- Opportunity and career mapping
- Storytelling with evidence of impact
- Collaboration, feedback and influence
- Responsible AI and digital judgement
- TRIZ, reverse brainstorming and IP
- Industry engagement and pitching

■ Takeaway toolkit

- A personal T-shaped capability and opportunity map
- An employer-ready professional story supported by evidence
- An inventive solution developed through TRIZ and reverse brainstorming
- A practical 60-day learning, networking and collaboration sprint

■ Custom program

Custom programs can be discussed

The scope can be shaped around the cohort, institutional priorities and desired outcomes. Workbook, capability map, pitch template and participation certificate can be included.

CONNECTING TECHNOLOGY TO EMOTIONS

Build campus capability in human-centred AI, responsible technology and experience innovation

⚡ **VALUE PROMISE:** Human insight • Responsible AI • Interdisciplinary innovation



AUDIENCE

Students, teachers & designers



DURATION

1 day | 9:30-17:00



FORMAT

Design & prototype lab



CUSTOM PROGRAM

Discuss with us

■ Why this matters now

FOR ACADEMIC LEADERS

Position the institution at the intersection of human-centred AI, responsible technology and interdisciplinary innovation.

WHY STUDENTS NEED IT

Students learn to design around trust, emotion, inclusion and ethics - capabilities central to AI, products and meaningful technology adoption.

WHY ACADEMICIANS NEED IT

Academicians open interdisciplinary research directions, differentiated IP and funding opportunities in human-centred AI and responsible technology.

■ What we will explore

- Recognise emotional tensions as sources of novel technology problems.
- Use stories and empathy evidence to guide responsible solution design.
- Balance usefulness, privacy, trust and inclusion through inventive frameworks.

■ What participants gain

- **Find unmet needs:** reveal novel human-technology problems worth researching.
- **Deepen contribution:** move beyond feature iterations to meaningful experience innovation.
- **Create defensible ideas:** shape non-obvious concepts with patent potential.
- **Build support:** present an ethical, partner-ready case for collaboration and funding.

INSTITUTIONAL RETURN

New interdisciplinary projects, responsible-AI research directions and partner-ready technology concepts.

Design for trust, agency and meaningful adoption

Participants use empathy evidence, emotional tensions and responsible design lenses to find better problems and build more human technology.

■ One-day learning journey

09:30-10:15	Technology is an emotional experience	Use trust, anxiety, agency and belonging as innovation signals.
10:15-11:15	Find unmet needs	Use empathy interviews, emotional vocabulary and bias-aware observation.
11:30-12:45	Map the experience	Build personas, emotion journeys, moments that matter and design principles.
13:45-15:00	Invent around tensions	Use TRIZ for privacy-personalisation, ease-control and speed-care.
15:15-16:15	Reverse brainstorm and IP lens	Transform failure modes into differentiated solution concepts.
16:15-17:00	Prototype with care	Pitch value, patent potential, emotional signals and ethical safeguards.

■ Who should attend

- Engineering, design, management and psychology students
- Teachers and researchers in technology-enabled learning, HCI and AI
- Product, UX and innovation teams in academic incubators

■ Methods & tools

- Emotion-led problem discovery
- Empathy interviews and journey maps
- Human-centred and inclusive design
- Foundations of affective computing
- TRIZ, reverse brainstorming and IP lens
- Partner pitch, trust and responsible testing

■ Takeaway toolkit

- An emotion journey map grounded in empathy evidence
- Human-technology tensions translated into design principles
- Differentiated concepts generated through TRIZ and reverse brainstorming
- A low-fidelity prototype with trust, inclusion and ethics checks

■ Custom program

Custom programs can be discussed

The scope can be shaped around the cohort, institutional priorities and desired outcomes. Workbook, empathy/IP/ethics canvases, prototype materials and participation certificate can be included.

THE ART OF STORYTELLING IN EDUCATION

A narrative-thinking lab for ideas, research, presentations and student leadership

🔧 VALUE PROMISE: Meaning • Evidence • Memory • Influence

04

PROGRAM



AUDIENCE

**Students, researchers &
faculty**



DURATION

1 day | 9:30-17:00



FORMAT

Story lab



CUSTOM PROGRAM

Discuss with us

■ Why this matters now

FOR ACADEMIC LEADERS

Build a campus capability that helps students and researchers make complex ideas understandable, memorable and relevant to real audiences.

WHY STUDENTS NEED IT

Students may already learn presentation skills, but storytelling goes further: it teaches how to structure meaning, create relevance, translate evidence and make an idea memorable.

WHY ACADEMICIANS NEED IT

Academicians can use narrative thinking to strengthen teaching, research communication, supervision, grant pitches and industry conversations without sacrificing rigor.

■ Beyond soft skills

- Soft skills often cover speaking fluency, etiquette, confidence and presentation presence.
- Storytelling trains narrative structure, audience insight, evidence translation and memory.
- It is a thinking discipline before it becomes a speaking technique.

■ What participants gain

- **Make meaning:** organise complexity into a clear narrative.
- **Explain research:** connect problem, contribution, evidence and limitation.
- **Pitch innovation:** make the human problem and proposed future visible.
- **Lead with clarity:** adapt the same idea for professors, reviewers, employers or public audiences.

INSTITUTIONAL RETURN

Students who can make rigorous ideas legible to reviewers, employers, juries, partners and wider audiences.

Storytelling is not the same as soft-skills training

The focus is narrative thinking: selecting meaning, structuring evidence and helping a specific audience understand why an idea matters.

■ One-day learning journey

09:30-10:15	Why stories work	Explore attention, memory, meaning and the difference between information and narrative.
10:15-11:15	Audience and purpose	Identify what a professor, reviewer, employer, investor or public audience needs to understand.
11:30-12:45	Narrative architecture	Build beginning, tension, insight, evidence and resolution around an idea.
13:45-15:00	Research storytelling	Turn a paper or project into a clear story of problem, contribution and evidence.
15:15-16:15	Visual narrative	Use slides, figures and examples as a guided reasoning journey rather than decoration.
16:15-17:00	Three-minute story lab	Deliver, receive critique and revise for clarity, credibility and impact.

■ Who should attend

- Undergraduate and postgraduate students
- Research scholars and project teams
- Innovation and entrepreneurship cohorts
- Faculty presenters and student leaders

■ Methods & tools

- Audience-purpose map
- Story spine and narrative arc
- Evidence-to-story canvas
- Research contribution narrative
- Visual storytelling principles
- Voice, pacing, questions and pauses

■ Takeaway toolkit

- A story map for a live academic or project topic
- A three-minute idea story
- A research or project narrative
- A one-slide story and final pitch
- A feedback-and-revision plan

■ Custom program

Custom programs can be discussed

The scope can be shaped around the cohort, institutional priorities and desired outcomes. Story canvas, narrative templates, feedback rubric and participation certificate can be included.

Three pillars of innovation

An idea becomes strategically interesting when it is **unique**, **hard to do** and **value adding** at the same time. The programs build student capability across all three.

01 UNIQUENESS

Meaningfully different

Students learn to ask whether the problem, insight or solution is genuinely different from what already exists - not merely a new implementation of a familiar idea.

SKILLS BUILT

Problem discovery, reframing, prior-art awareness, assumption breaking, divergent thinking and TRIZ.

02 HARD TO DO

Technically defensible

Innovation needs technical or execution depth. Students learn to work with constraints, contradictions, evidence and experiments so the idea is more than a superficial concept. **SKILLS**

BUILT

Systems thinking, technical trade-offs, experimentation, prototyping, non-obviousness and execution discipline.

03 VALUE ADDING

Creates real value

A clever idea is not automatically valuable. Students learn to connect innovation to a real user, institution, industry or societal need and define the change it should create. **SKILLS**

BUILT

Stakeholder insight, outcome framing, evidence, adoption thinking, value articulation and storytelling.

■ Why all three have to come together

Unique + valuable, but easy to copy

Interesting, but difficult to defend or sustain.

Unique + hard, but low value

Technically impressive, but unlikely to matter outside the project.

Hard + valuable, but not unique

Useful engineering, but limited differentiation or innovation claim.

Unique + hard + value adding

A stronger foundation for defensible innovation and meaningful impact.

■ How I help students build the three muscles

DISCOVER

Find tensions, unmet needs and consequential problems.

CHALLENGE

Question assumptions and seek a genuinely different angle.

BUILD

Work through constraints, contradictions and technical depth.

VALIDATE

Test evidence, stakeholder value, utility and feasibility.

COMMUNICATE

Turn the work into a research, patent or industry story.

THE CORE HABIT

Do not ask only, "Can we build it?" Ask: "Is it different? Is it difficult enough to be defensible? Does it create enough value to matter?"

What the three pillars are designed to enable

The objective is not idea generation for its own sake. Students learn to convert differentiated, substantive and useful ideas into stronger research, invention and industry-facing evidence.

■ Outcome 01 - Impactful research

UNIQUENESS

A consequential question, clearer research gap and a contribution that is meaningfully different.

HARD TO DO

Technical depth, rigorous methods, experiments, difficult trade-offs and credible evidence.

VALUE ADDING

A problem that matters to a field, stakeholder, industry, society or future system.

STUDENT-OWNED EVIDENCE

Problem landscape • novelty map • research question • experiment plan • contribution statement • publication pathway.

■ Outcome 02 - Patents and defensible IP

UNIQUENESS

Prior-art awareness and a clearly differentiated mechanism, method or system element.

HARD TO DO

Non-obvious technical substance, constraints and implementation depth that make the idea defensible.

VALUE ADDING

Utility, adoption potential and a reason the invention should exist beyond novelty alone.

STUDENT-OWNED EVIDENCE

Invention canvas • prior-art search terms • novelty hypothesis • non-obviousness rationale • prototype or evidence plan.

■ Outcome 03 - Industry-ready innovators

UNIQUENESS

Spot opportunities others miss and frame a differentiated response rather than repeating obvious solutions.

HARD TO DO

Move from idea to execution: handle constraints, collaborate, experiment, learn and improve.

VALUE ADDING

Connect technical work to business, user and societal outcomes and explain why it matters.

STUDENT-OWNED EVIDENCE

Problem brief • prototype or concept • decision rationale • outcome story • pitch • 30/60-day action plan.

WHAT ACADEMIC LEADERS CAN REVIEW AFTER A COHORT

Problem portfolio • research directions • possible IP candidates • experiment plans • industry-facing pitches • participant capability evidence • recommended next steps.

The program builds capability and stronger pathways. Publication, patent and hiring outcomes are not guaranteed and depend on the quality of subsequent work, evidence, review and execution.

Dr Amar Banerjee

Bridging research curiosity, inventive thinking and real-world impact



■ My story of innovation

My journey began in control and automation research, where I learned that a technically elegant answer is valuable only when it addresses a problem that truly matters. Across industrial systems, healthcare, AI and enterprise innovation, one question remained constant: **how does an idea travel from insight to experiment, patent, partnership and impact?**

The biggest barrier is rarely a shortage of ideas. It is often the absence of a shared language between researchers, students, institutional leaders and industry teams. These programs are designed to create that language together.

■ The experience I promise

1 • BEGIN WITH CURIOSITY

Start with lived experiences, tensions, anomalies and unmet needs - not a pre-selected solution.

3 • INVENT WITH DISCIPLINE

TRIZ, reverse brainstorming and structured experimentation turn imagination into defensible concepts.

2 • MAKE PROBLEM VISIBLE

Stories, evidence and stakeholder perspectives reveal what conventional framing misses.

4 • LEAVE WITH NEXT MOVE

Every participant converts learning into a tangible canvas, prototype, pitch or action roadmap.

■ A shared innovation vocabulary

Academia often begins with knowledge; industry often begins with value. A shared sequence makes collaboration easier to initiate and sustain. **PROBLEM** worth solving **EVIDENCE** that matters

TENSION to resolve **INVENTION** with novelty

EXPERIMENT to learn **IMPACT** to scale

My facilitation promise

The room will be safe enough to question assumptions, rigorous enough to challenge easy answers and practical enough to produce something participants can use the next morning.

How I facilitate innovation

Research depth, invention experience and a practical path from problem to proof.

■ What I bring into the room

- 12+ years across research, applied AI and industrial R&D
- 30+ publications and 25+ filed patents
- 7 granted patents
- Experience connecting technology, research rigor and human-centred innovation
- Teaching, facilitation and mentoring across academic and professional cohorts

■ My promise to students

You will not be asked merely to “think outside the box.”
You will learn how to find a better box: a meaningful problem, a useful contradiction and a credible path from idea to opportunity.

■ How we will work together

- Short stories and cases that make complex ideas relatable
- Individual reflection followed by collaborative studio work
- Frameworks used on participants’ own academic and professional challenges
- Constructive critique that improves novelty, relevance and clarity
- Reusable canvases that continue after the workshop

■ My invitation to academic leaders

Let us create a campus culture where publication is not the finish line, patents are not isolated trophies and industry engagement is not transactional. Together, we can help students and faculty connect knowledge, invention and societal value through a vocabulary everyone can use.

CREDIBILITY BEHIND THE PRACTICE

PhD, IIT Hyderabad • IEEE Senior Member
Visiting Professor, COEP Technological University
Reviewer for international journals and conferences

■ The shift I want to enable

Publication as the endpoint	→	Knowledge as a starting point
Research topics inherited	→	Problems actively discovered
Ideas discussed and admired	→	Experiments designed and tested
Industry invited at the end	→	Partners engaged around shared value

START WITH ONE COHORT

Choose one capability. Define one visible change. Run the pilot. Review the evidence.

LET'S BUILD YOUR INSTITUTION'S NEXT INNOVATION PIPELINE

From a one-day workshop to a repeatable campus capability



■ The collaboration pitch

Institutions rarely lack talent, ideas or ambition. The missing link is often a shared, repeatable pathway that connects academic curiosity to a problem worth solving - and then carries that problem towards an experiment, intellectual property, funding, an industry partnership or measurable student opportunity.

I collaborate with academic leaders to design learning engagements around the institution's real priorities. The aim is not to conduct another isolated event. It is to leave behind a common vocabulary, practical tools, visible outputs and the confidence to keep innovating.

■ Value-led engagement options

- 01 Signature Workshop | One day:** Create a shared vocabulary, practise the frameworks and leave with participant-owned canvases, concepts and action plans.
- 02 Capability Sprint | Modular series:** Combine workshops, guided application and a review clinic so faculty or student teams can apply the methods to live institutional challenges.
- 03 Innovation Partnership | Custom pathway:** Integrate challenge labs, research-to-IP clinics, leadership conversations and follow-through support around a defined campus or industry priority.

Formats can include faculty development, student bootcamps, research clinics, industry-academia challenge labs and leadership roundtables.

■ A simple path from conversation to impact

01 LISTEN

Clarify the audience, institutional priority and desired outcome.

03 FACILITATE

Create an energetic studio where participants build together.

02 DESIGN

Tailor cases, tools, challenges and participant deliverables.

04 SUSTAIN

Provide canvases and a follow-through roadmap for continued action.

What the institution can gain

A collaboration is designed around visible capability, reusable tools and a practical path for continuation after the event.

■ What the institution can gain

- A visible portfolio of novel, relevant problems
- Stronger patent, proposal and funding concepts
- Better research stories for industry and government stakeholders
- Employer-relevant evidence of student capability
- Interdisciplinary teams aligned around shared challenges
- Reusable innovation tools that extend beyond the event

■ Value-based scoping

Custom programs can be discussed based on the cohort, institutional priorities and desired outcomes. Each engagement is shaped around outcomes, customisation and follow-through - not delivery hours alone.

■ Program portfolio

01 • INNOVATION IN ACADEMIA

Find consequential problems; move from incremental publication to patent, partnership and funding pathways.

02 • THE MODERN-DAY PROFESSIONAL

Build judgement, narrative and inventive confidence needed to convert knowledge into opportunity.

03 • CONNECTING TECHNOLOGY TO EMOTIONS

Create human-centred technology concepts that people can trust, value and adopt.

04 • THE ART OF STORYTELLING IN EDUCATION

Turn ideas, projects and research into narratives people can understand, remember and act on.

Start the conversation

Share your priority, participant profile and intended outcome. I will help shape an engagement relevant to your campus and designed around tangible next steps.

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LOW-RISK STARTING PATH

Choose one cohort. Define one measurable capability. Run the pilot. Review the evidence. Scale what works.